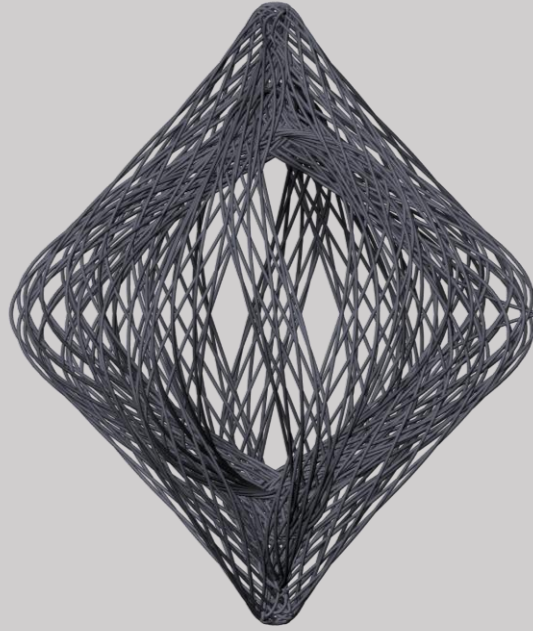




portfolio

N I M A Z A H I R I



NIMA ZAHIRI

Civil Eng., Ph.D. Timber Construction

Email: zahiri.nima@gmail.com

Phone: +47 459 15 627

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/nimazahiri/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nimazahiri/)

Web-page: nimazahiri.github.io

Bernau bei Berlin, Germany

QUALIFICATIONS

International work experience
Top-tier academic education
Technical professional portfolio
Broad software expertise
Solid production competence
Multilingual communication skills

ACADEMIC EDUCATION

Ph.D. Timber Construction

2023 Computational Design
2020 and Automated Production
NTNU Gjøvik, NO

M.Sc. ITECH

2019 Integrative Technologies and
2017 Architectural Design Research
University of Stuttgart, DE

B.Sc. Civil Engineering

2011 Structural and
2006 Building Construction
Razi University, IR

SOFTWARE EXPERTISE

Parametric Design – Grasshopper
Programming – Python, C#
BIM Modeling – Revit
FE Simulation – Karamba3D, Fusion 360
Timber Construction – cadwork, SEMA
Fabrication – Hundegger Cambium

WORK EXPERIENCE

Timber Construction Designer

Now. Design and Planning of
2023 Modular Timber Construction
timpla GmbH, Eberswalde, DE

Designer / 3D Specialist

2020 Computational Design of
Complex Concrete Reinforcement
Werner Sobek AG, Stuttgart, DE

Research Assistant

2019 Research Support in
2017 Doctoral Projects
University of Stuttgart, DE

Project Engineer

2016 Building Information Modelling
2014 And Construction Detailing
T.AHA Architecture, Tehran, IR

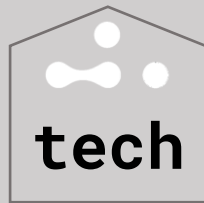
LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY

Persian – native
English – fluent at an academic level
German – advanced working proficiency
Norwegian – independent communication

This portfolio focuses on computational design,
integrated technologies and digital fabrication.

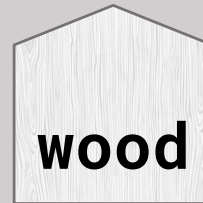
It consists of two chapters:

CHAPTER I



technology
projects

CHAPTER II



woodbased
projects



Please see in full screen

CHAPTER I



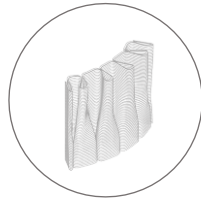
technology
projects

The first chapter focuses on **integrative technologies** in architecture, in the context of computational design and digital fabrication.

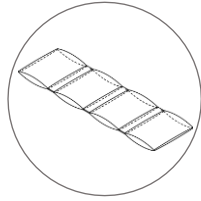
CHAPTER I



technology
projects



- 1 FUTURE TRADITION
Robotic Clay Printing



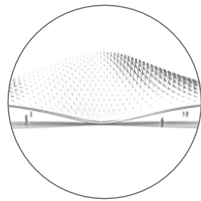
- 2 JOINT FREE MOVEMENT
Fiber Composite Production



- 3 T-BEAM
Bending Active Plates



- 4 FLECTOFOLD
Frame Steel CNC Fabrication



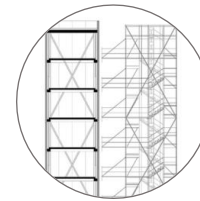
- 5 TRAIN STATION
Flectofold Competition Proposal



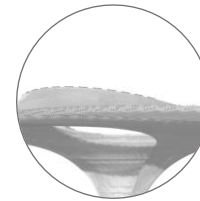
- 6 ITECH RESEARCH DEMONSTRATOR 2019
Biomimetic Adaptive Architecture



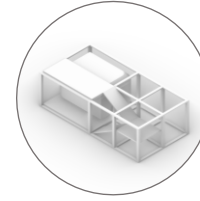
- 7 ELECTROACTIVE SKIN
Electroactive - Textile Production



- 8 ADAPTIVE TOWER
SFB1244 Demonstrator



- 9 MAIN STATION STUTTGART 21
Complex Concrete Reinforcement



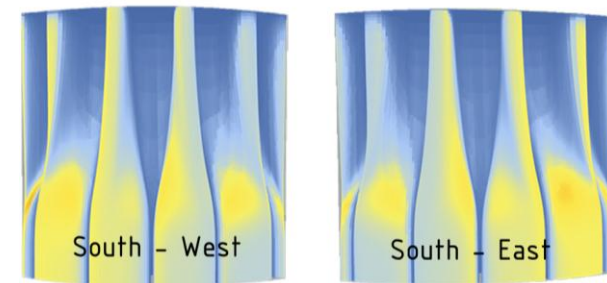
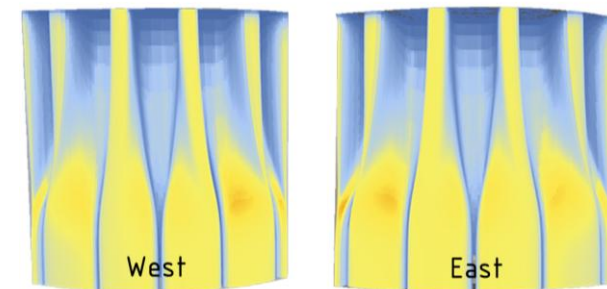
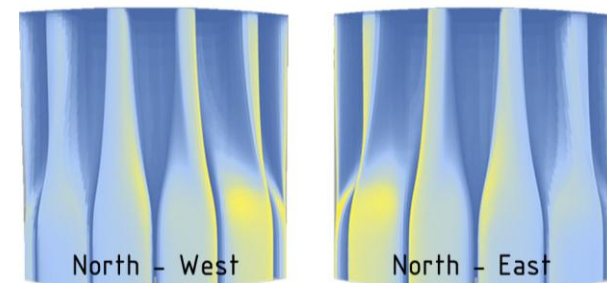
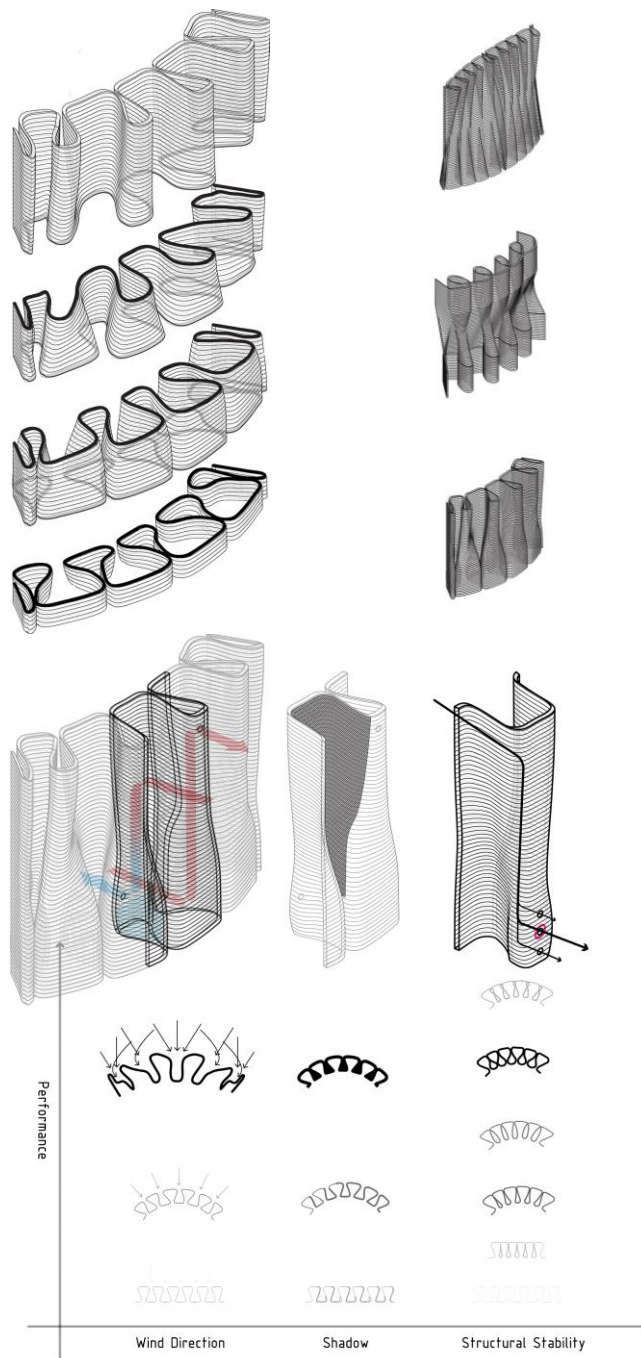
- 10 MODUS HIGH-RISES
Modular Procedural Assembly

work **FUTURE TRADITION**
 Rethink of Vernacular Clay Cooling System

tech KUKA Robotic Clay Printing, Environmental Analysis

role Competition: Future Tradition
 2016 Contemporary Architect Association (CAA), IR

task Entire Process



work **JOINT FREE MOVEMENT**
 Shape-changing Fiber Composite Plates

tech Pneumatic Cushions, Glass Fiber

role ITECH Course: Architectural Biomimetic
 2017 ICD Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

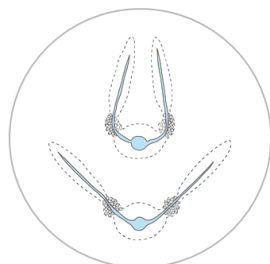
task Entire Process

The aim of this research project is to control the elastic stiffness and bending behavior of a fiber composite plate with pneumatic actuation.

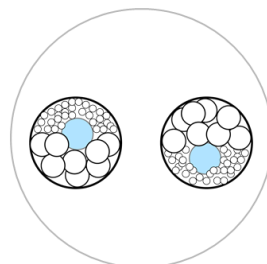
Biological Role Model: Mimosa Pudica



One branch

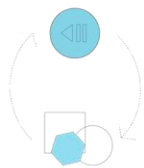


Petiole with leaves



Cells in Pulvini

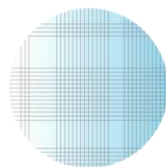
RELEVANT PRINCIPLES FOR ABSTRACTION



Fusion of actuators



Pressure change



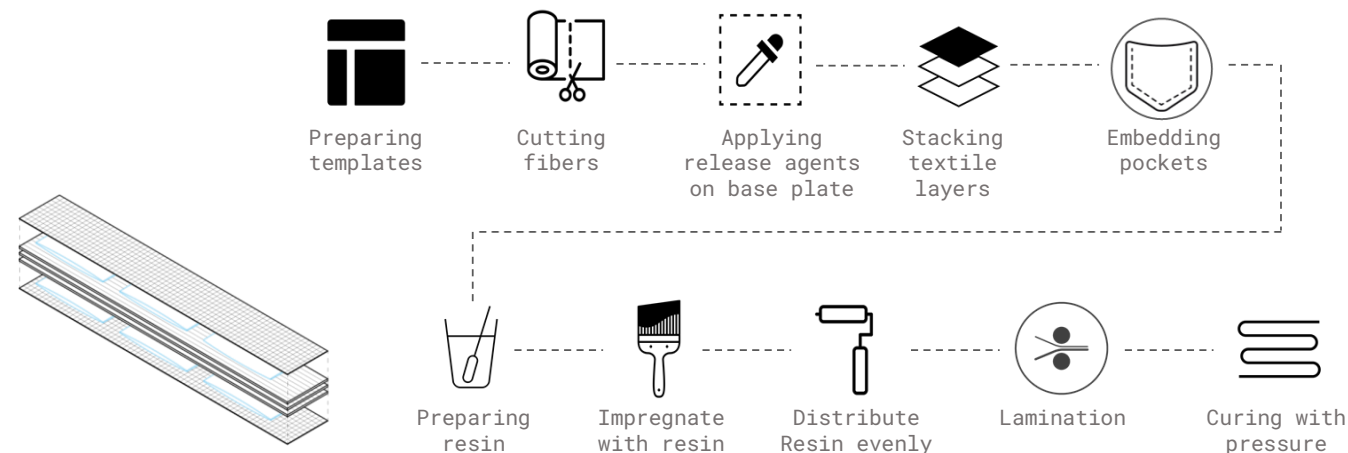
Material gradient



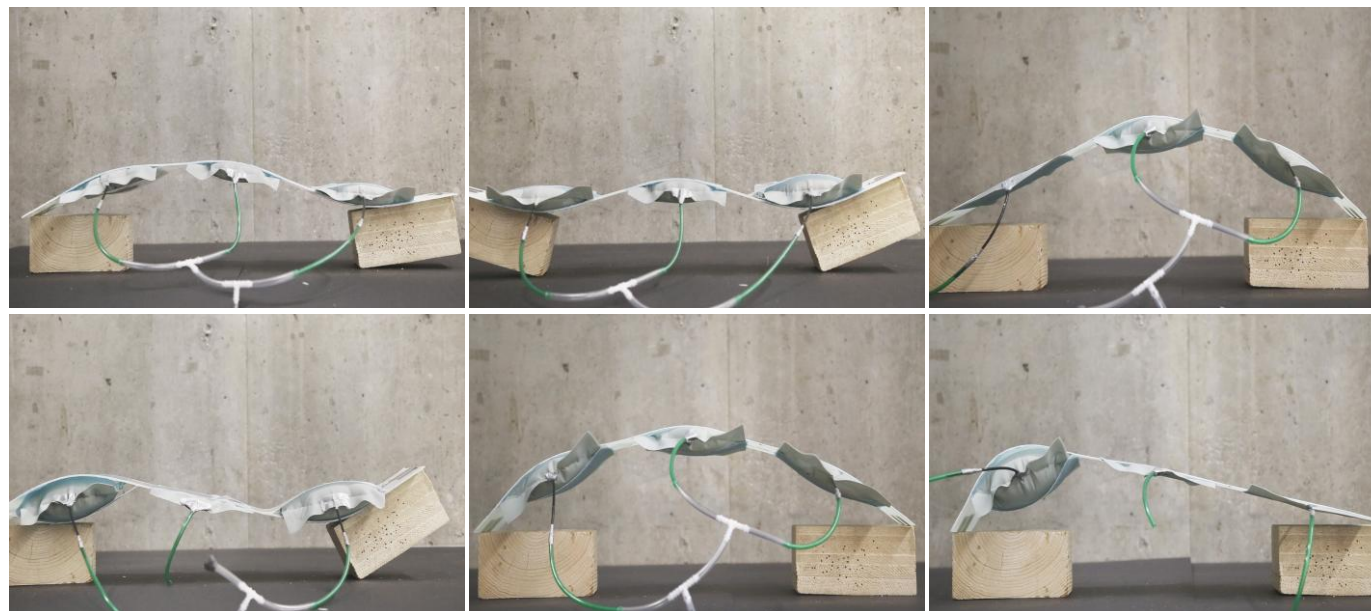
Compliance



Reversibility and freedom



1x Glass fiber woven fabric 0/60
 2x Plastic (pocket)
 3x Glass fiber fabric, unidirectional
 2x Plastic (pocket)
 1x Glass fiber woven fabric 0/60

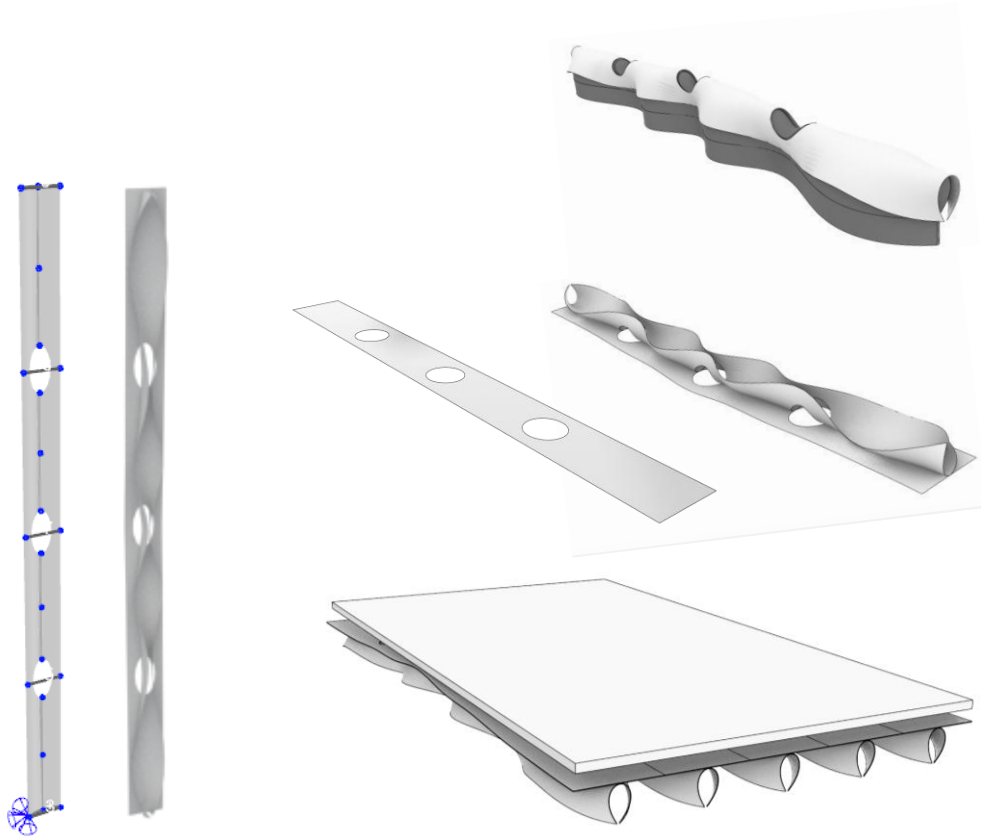


work **T-BEAM**
Curved Bending T Cross-sections

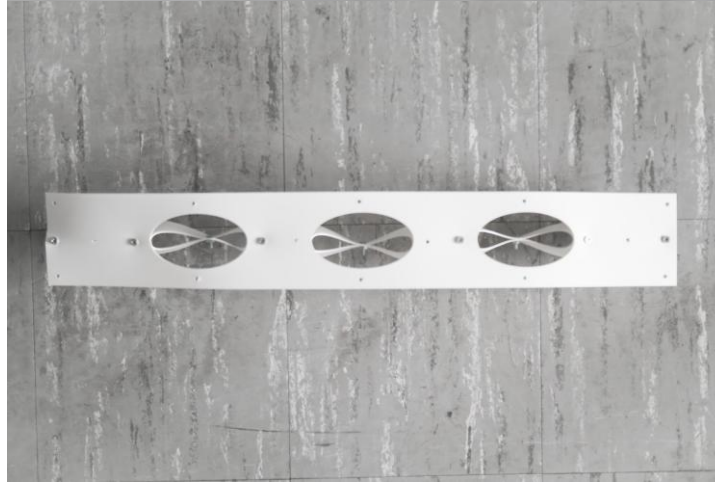
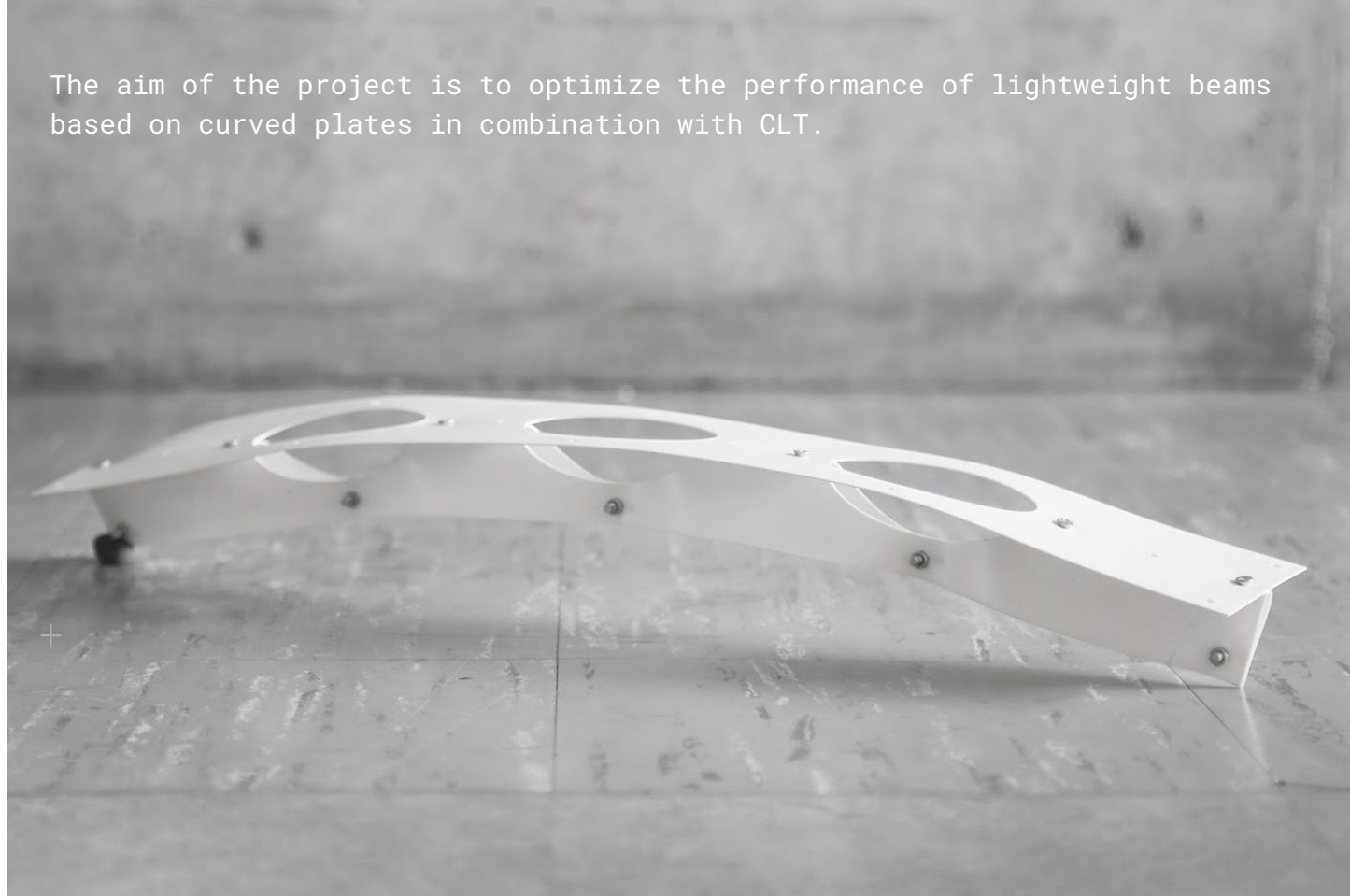
tech Typology Optimization and Manual Prototyping

role ITECH Course: Material and Structure
2018 ITKE Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

task Entire Process



The aim of the project is to optimize the performance of lightweight beams based on curved plates in combination with CLT.

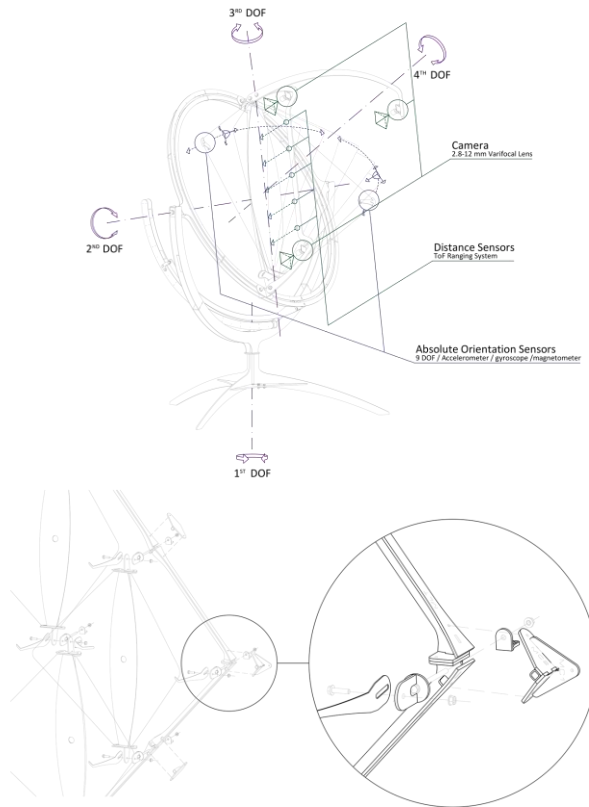


work **FLECTOFOLD**
Demonstrator & Performance Monitoring Device

tech Compliant Mechanism

role Student Assistant (HiWi)
2018 ITKE Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

task Design Development, Fabrication, Assembly



The aim of this project was to monitor, evaluate and showcase the potential of materially graduated FRP as a material solution for climate adaptive building envelopes. To read more, click [here](#).

work **TRAIN STATION**
FlectoFold Design Development

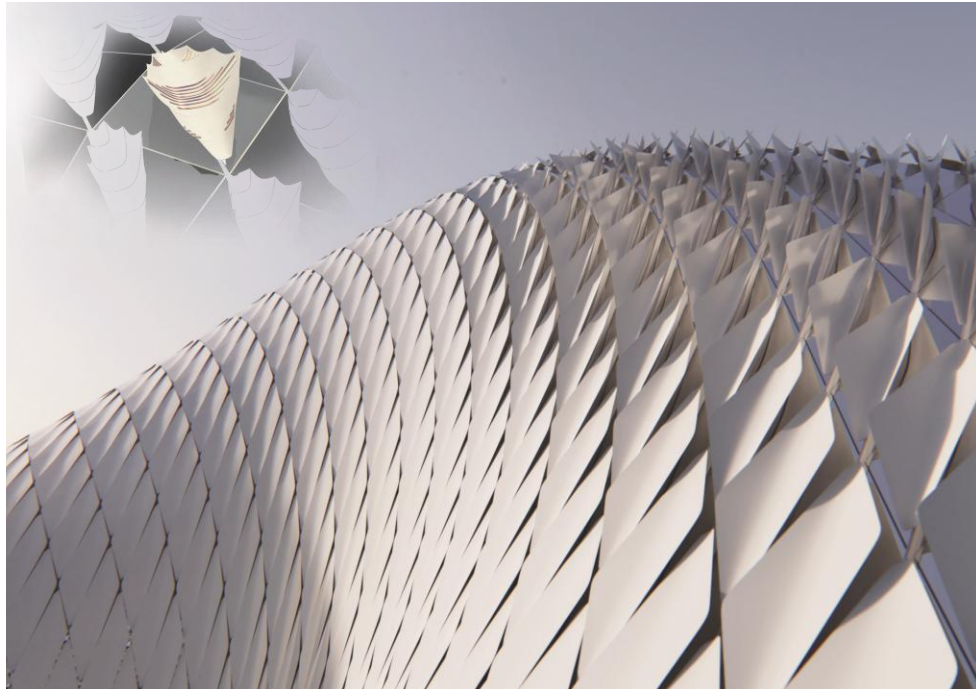
tech Compliant Mechanism

role Competition

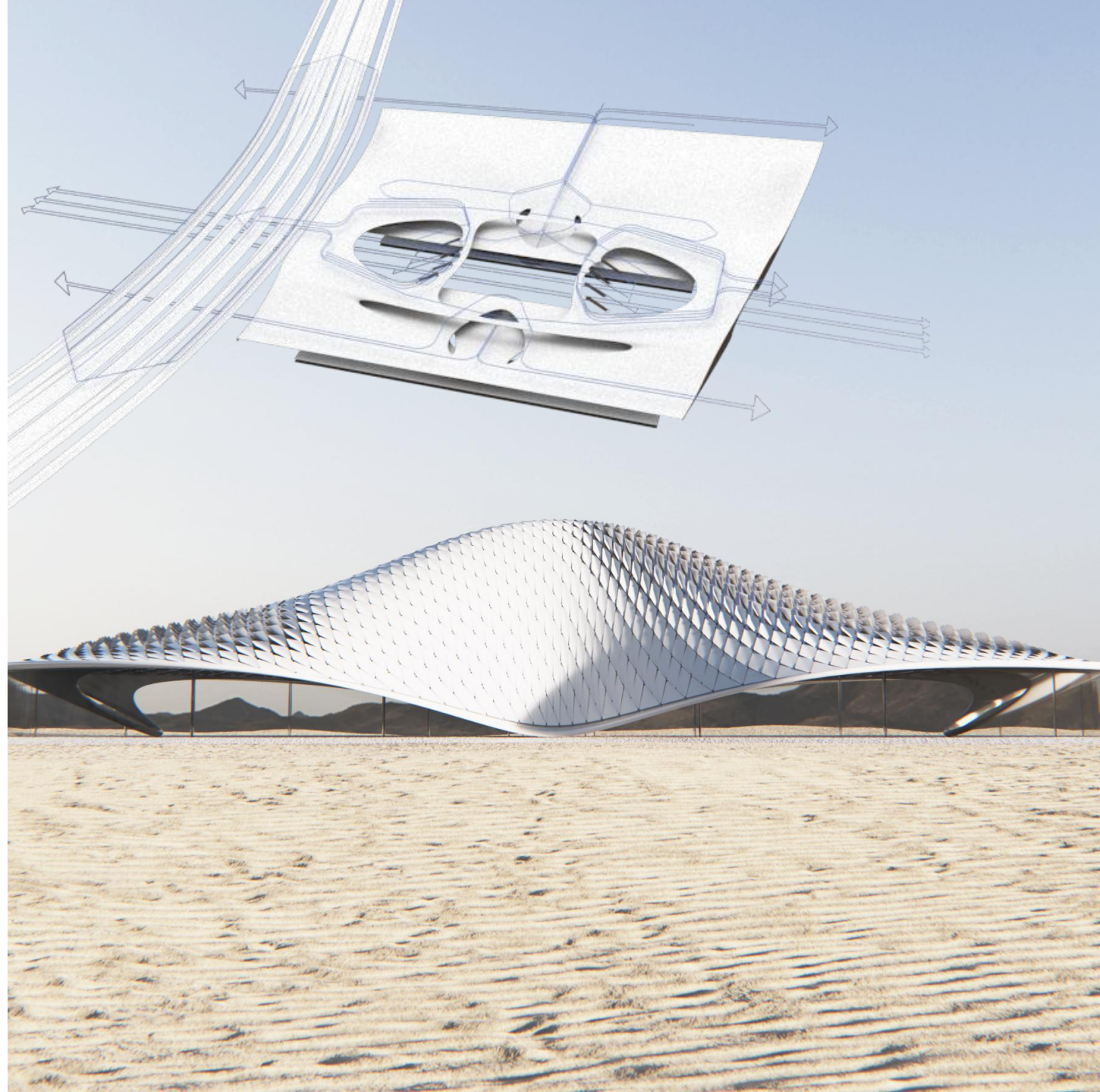
2018 Saman Saffarian Architecture Office, CZ

task Circulation Design and Functioning Diagrams

The aim of this project was to propose an airport using segmented Flectofold shell for environmental adaptation.



Pictures © Saman Saffarian



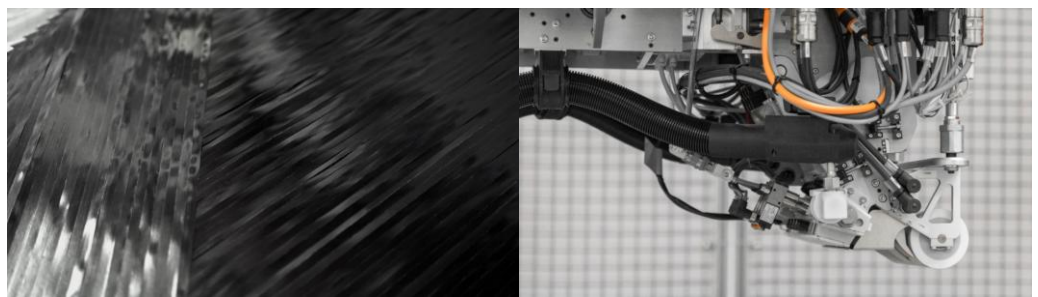
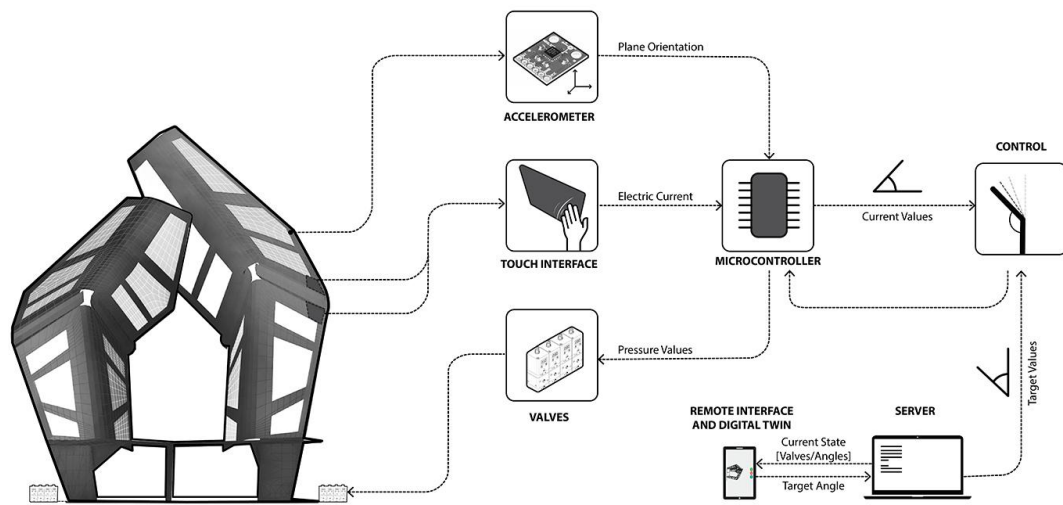
work **ITECH RESEARCH DEMONSTRATOR 2018-19**
 Biomimetic Adaptive Architecture

tech Robotic Carbon Fiber Placement, Haptic Adaptive

role ITECH Studio Project (2019)

2019 ICD / ITKE Institutes, University of Stuttgart, DE

task Simulation, Fabrication



Pictures © ITKE / ICD University of Stuttgart



The ITECH research demonstrator 2018/19 investigates large-scale compliant architecture inspired by the folding mechanisms of the Coleoptera Coccinellidae (Ladybug) wings. To read more click [here](#).

work **ELECTROACTIVE SKIN**
Towards Bio-inspired Responsive Envelopes

tech Integration of EAP with Textile

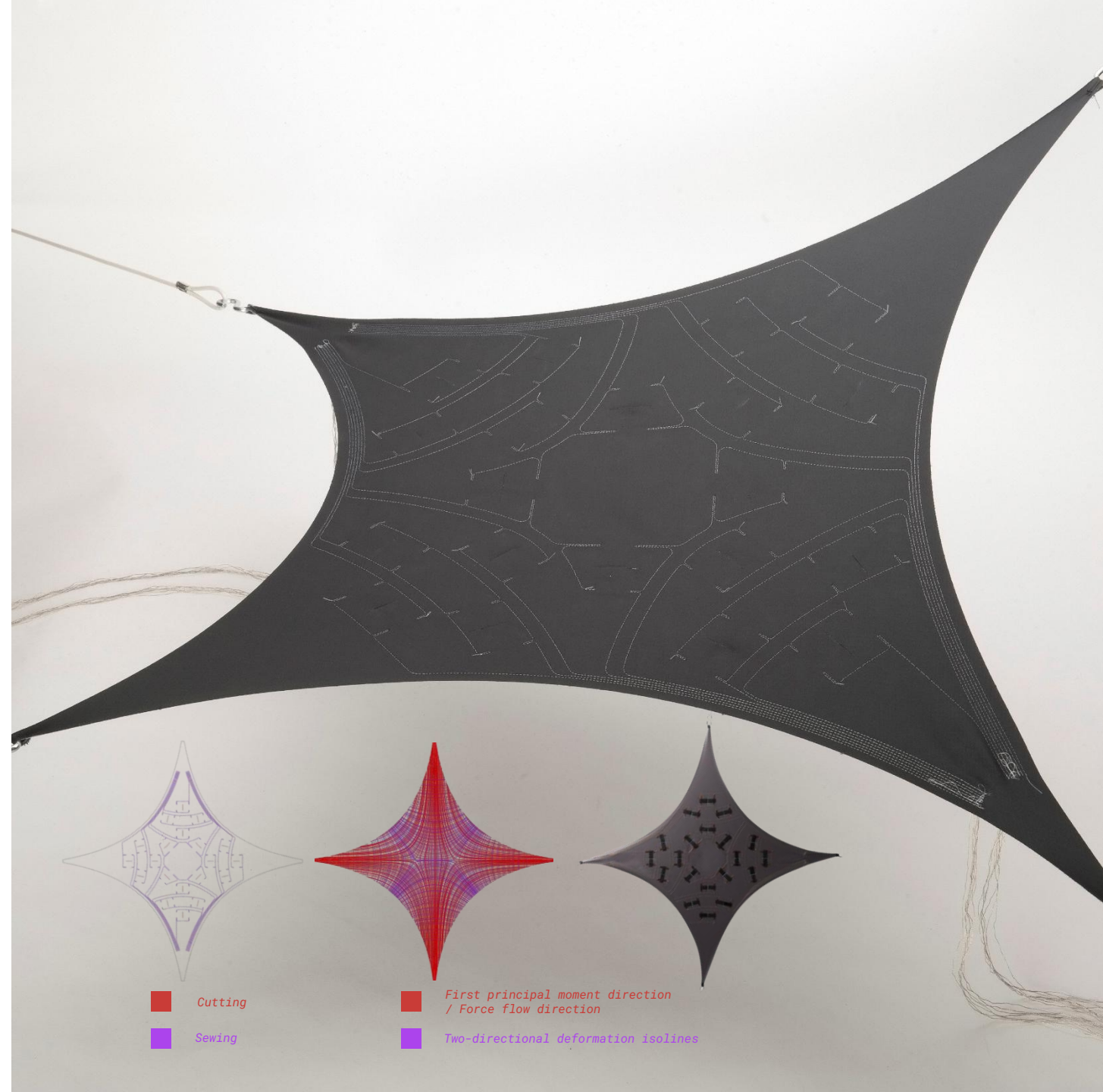
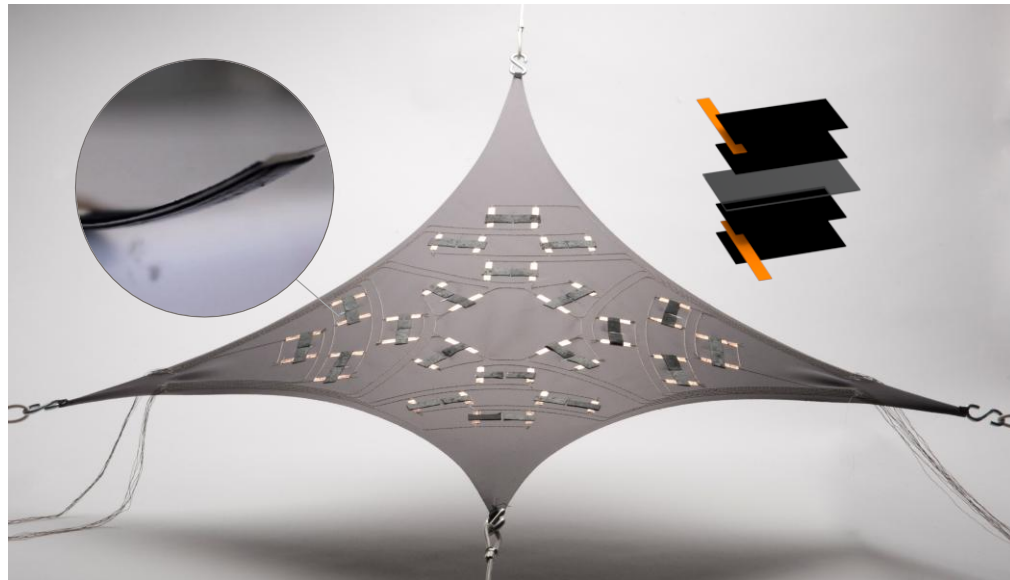
role Master's Thesis (2019)
2019 University of Stuttgart (BioMat/ITKE, ICD), DE
Fraunhofer Institute (IPA), DE
Institute of Aircraft Design (IFB), DE

task Entire Process

The aim of this research is to investigate actuatable apertures in architectural skin through incorporation of ionic electroactive polymer.

To see the video, click [here](#).

To read the published paper, click [here](#).

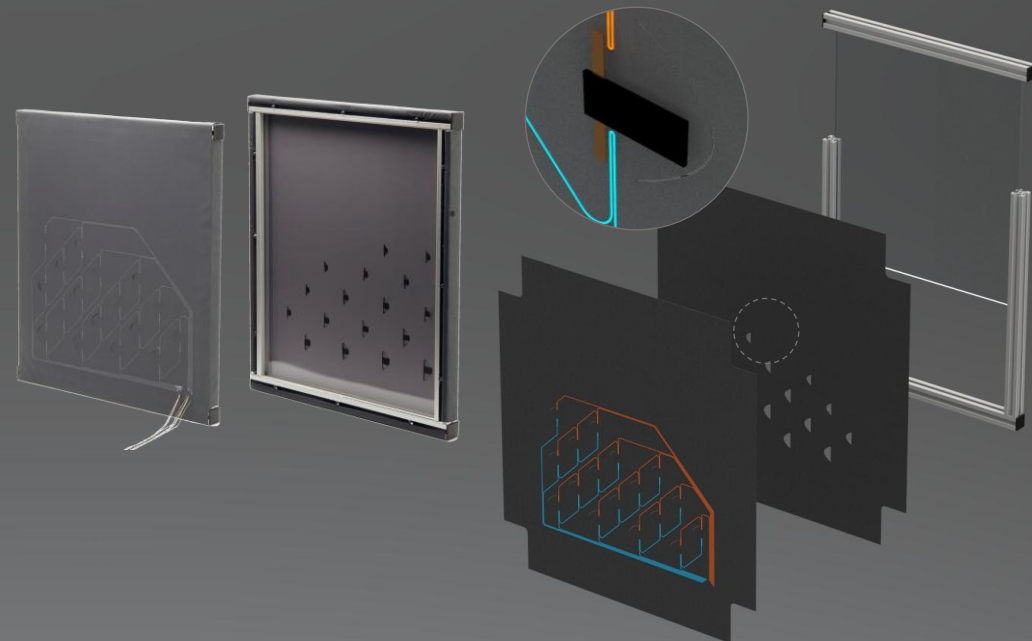
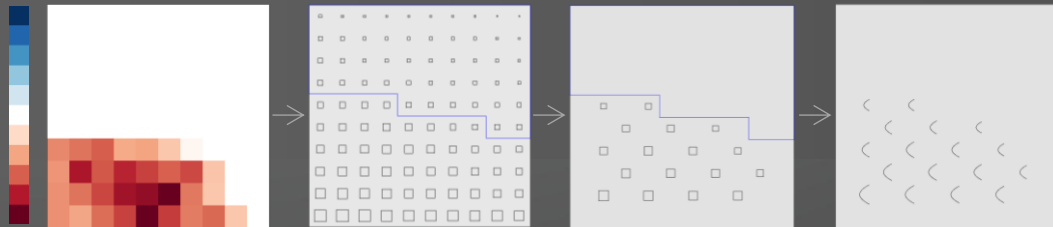


work **ADAPTIVE TOWER**
SFB1244 Adaptive Building Skin Demonstrator

tech Integration of EAP with Textile

role Master's Thesis (2019)
2019 University of Stuttgart (BioMat/ITKE, ICD), DE
Fraunhofer Institute (IPA), DE
Institute of Aircraft Design (IFB), DE

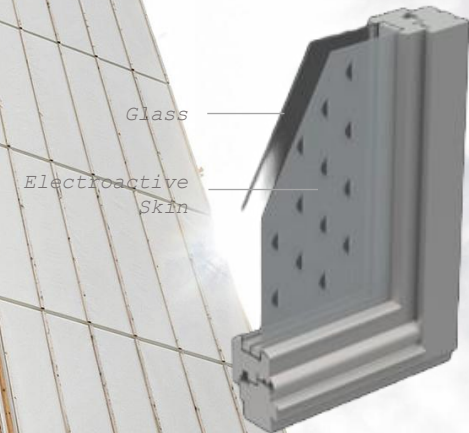
task Entire Process



This research contributes to the ongoing SFB1244 "Adaptive Building Skins and Structures for the Built Environment of Tomorrow", funded by the German Research Foundation (DFG) under the following schema:

C03 – Electroactive polymer actuators and arrays for switchable breathability in building skins

To read more, click [here](#).



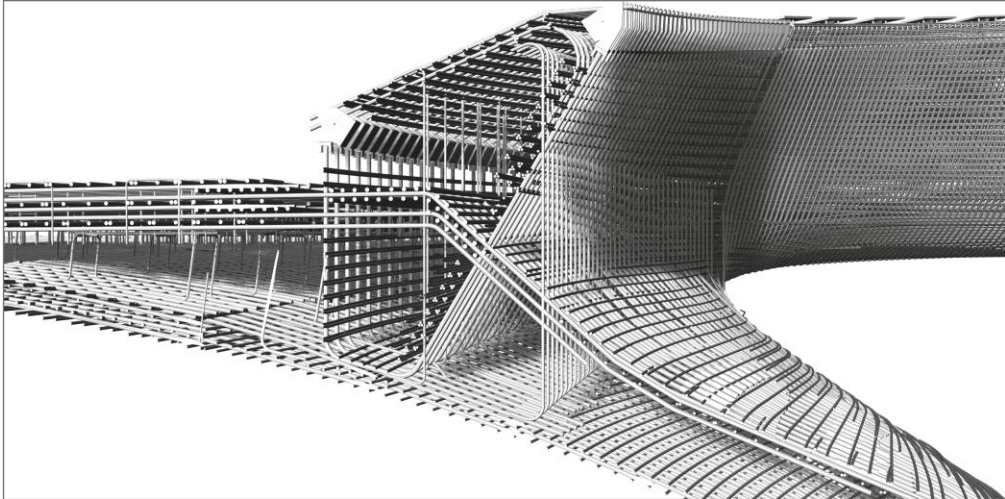
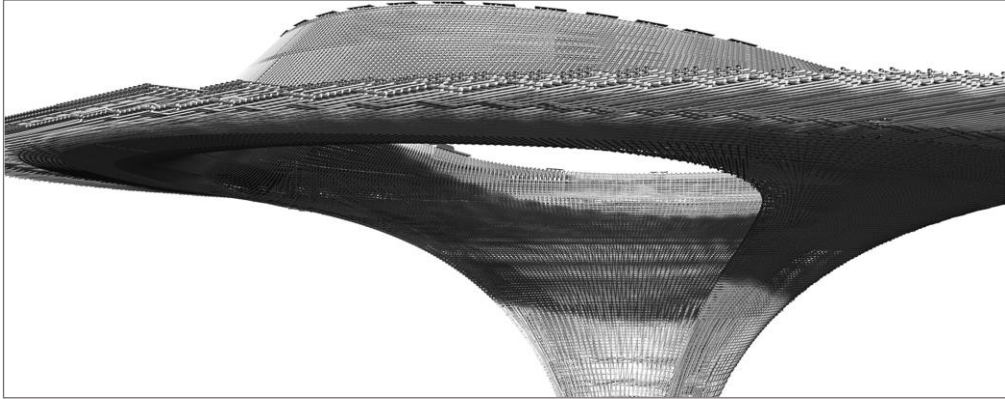
work **MAIN STATION STUTT GART 21**
Reinforced Concrete Shell

tech Computational

role Full-time Employment

2020 *Werner Sobek AG Stuttgart, DE*

task Computational Design



Stuttgart 21 is a transport and urban development project to reorganize the Stuttgart railway junction.



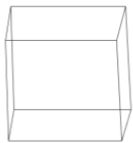
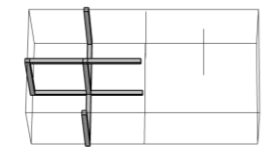
work **MODUS HIGH-RISES**
Modular Procedural Assembly

tech Computational Design

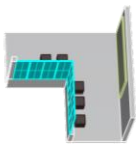
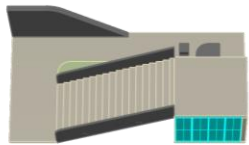
role Individual Project
2020 DesignMorphine Workshop

task Computation

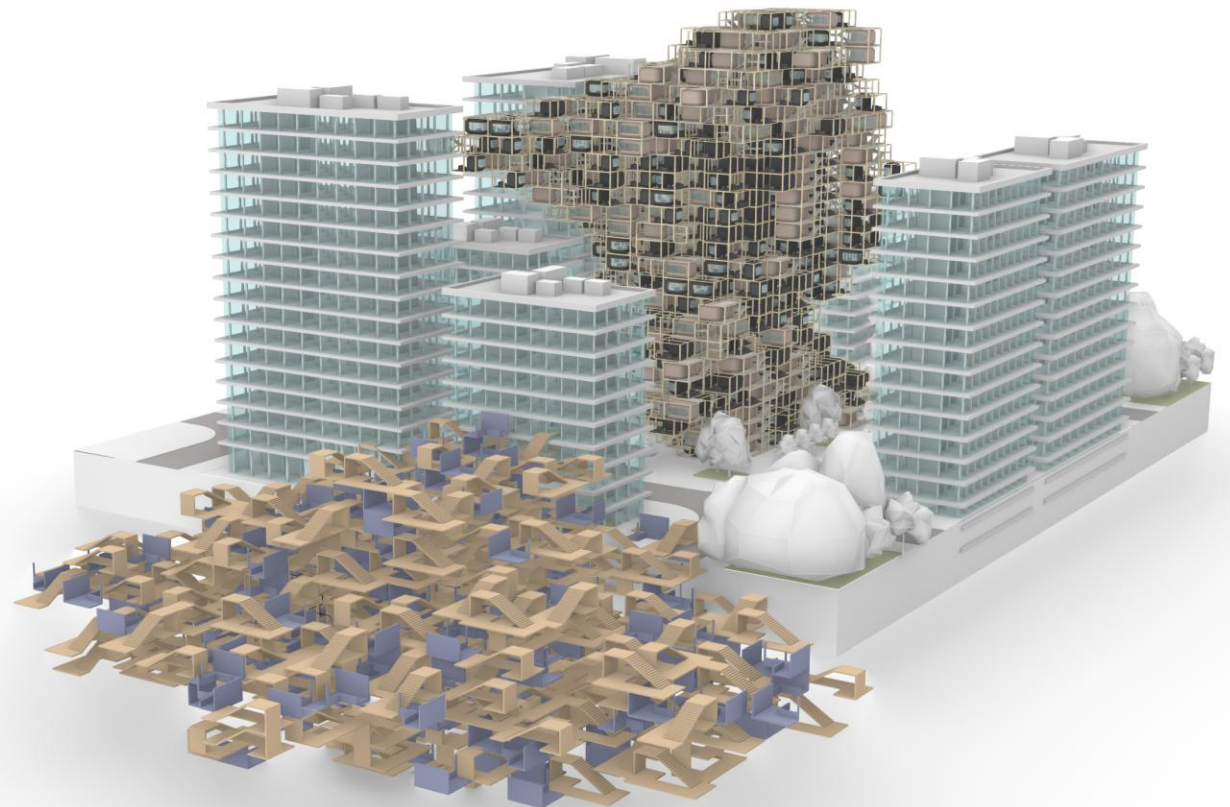
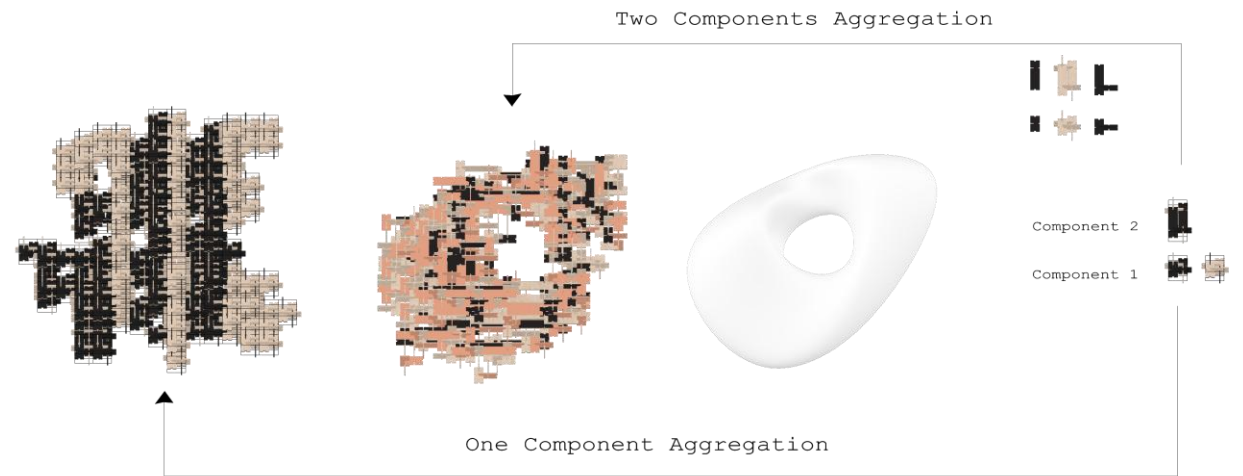
The aim is to create modular procedural modules via WASP within growing transformative spaces, that can react to the changing streams of the information society.



Modules Option 2



Modules Option 1



CHAPTER II



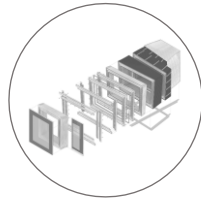
**woodbased
projects**

The second chapter includes **selected innovative timber projects**, each highlighting one aspect of wood and its associated fabrication techniques.

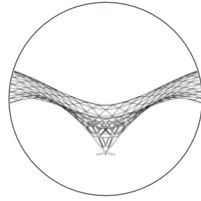
CHAPTER II



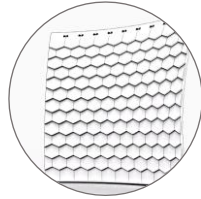
woodbased
projects



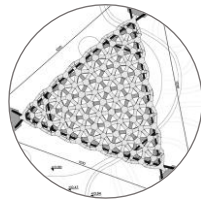
- 1 IBA TIMBER PROTOTYPE HOUSE
Advance CNC Fabrication



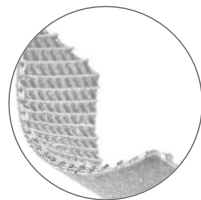
- 2 FUNICULAR TIMBER GRIDSHELL
Form-finding



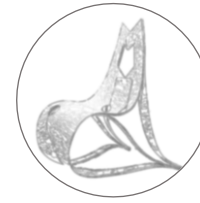
- 3 SHINGLE WALL
KUKA Robotic Fabrication



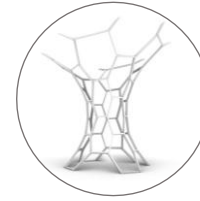
- 4 BIOMAT PAVILION
Vacuum Molding Bio-material



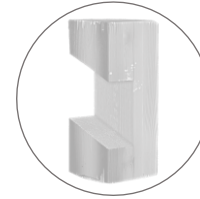
- 5 SMART BIO-STRUCTURE
Wood Filament 4D-Printing



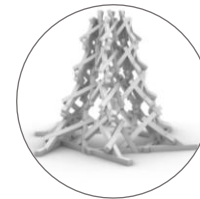
- 6 ODIN CHAIR
Bending Active CNC Plywood



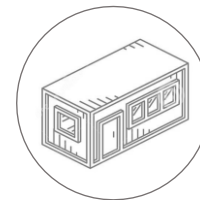
- 7 HEXA TOWER
Triple Scarf Timber Joinery



- 8 INTER-HYGRO-JOINERY
Hygroscopic Analysis via CT Scanning



- 9 INTERLOCKING TOWER
Hundegger Production and AR Assembly



- 10 MODULAR HOUSING
Timber Construction and Manufacturing

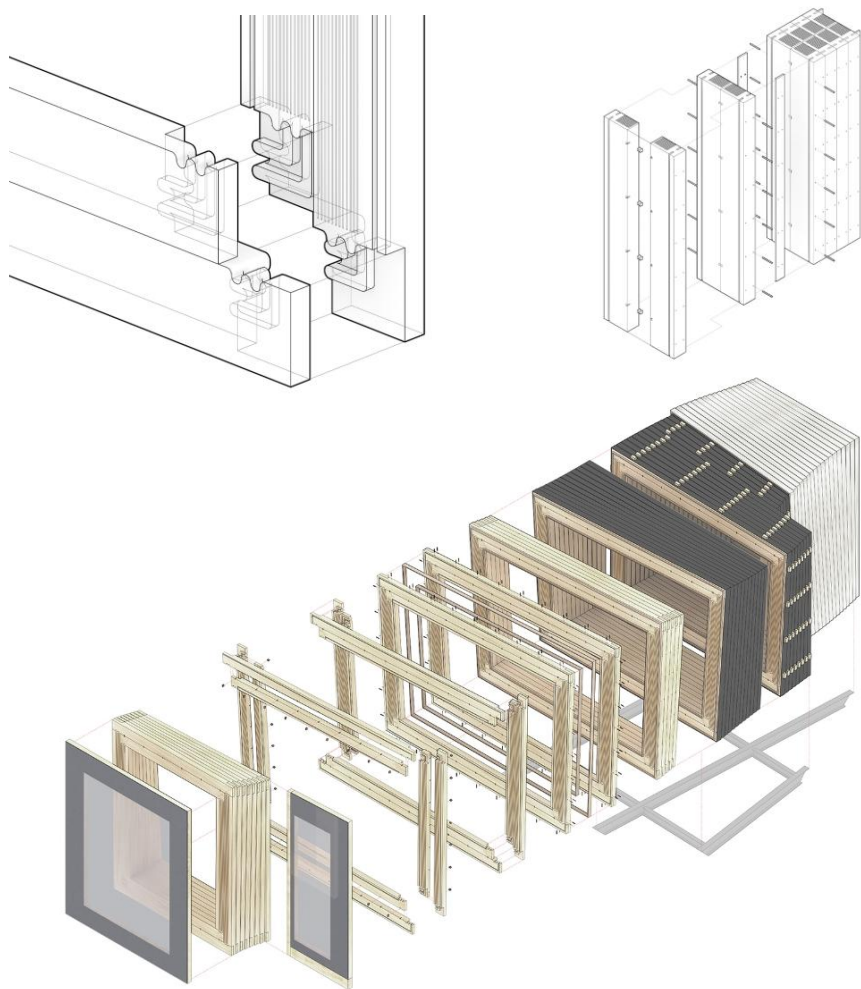
work **IBA TIMBER PROTOTYPE HOUSE**
Digital Log Cabin

tech Computational Design and CNC production

role Student Assistant (HiWi)

2017 ICD Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

task Construction



Pictures © ICD/ITKE University of Stuttgart

The IBA Timber Prototype House combines the benefits of traditional low-cost timber construction with advances in computational design and fabrication technologies. To read more click [here](#)

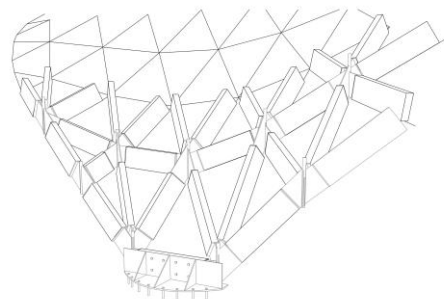
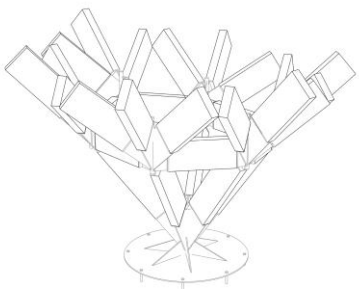
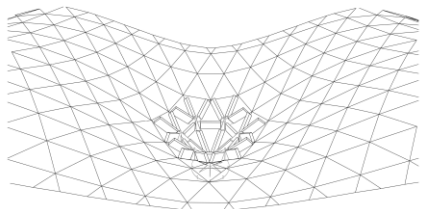
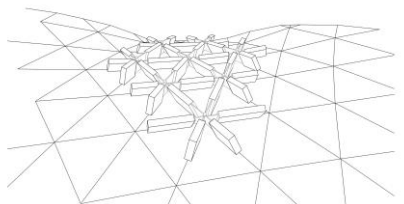
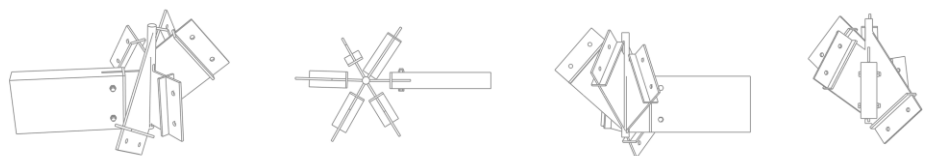


work **FUNICULAR TIMBER GRIDSELL**
Timber Grid-shell with Steel Connectors

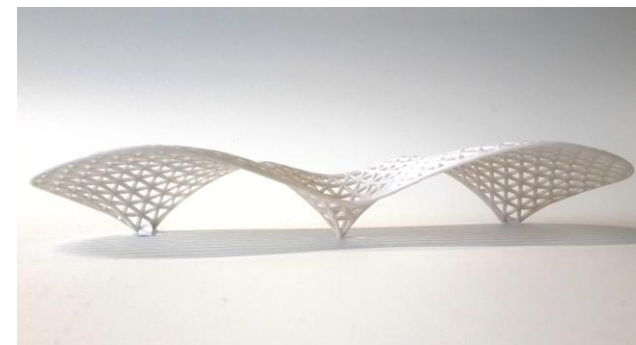
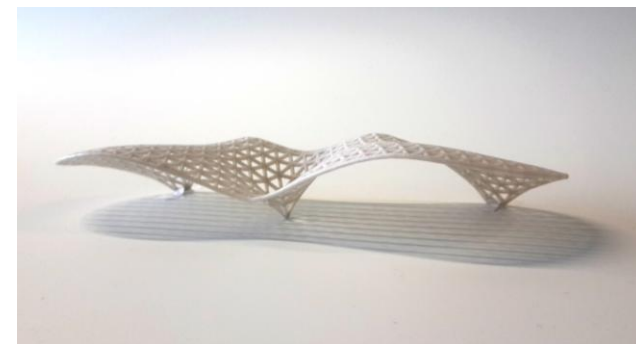
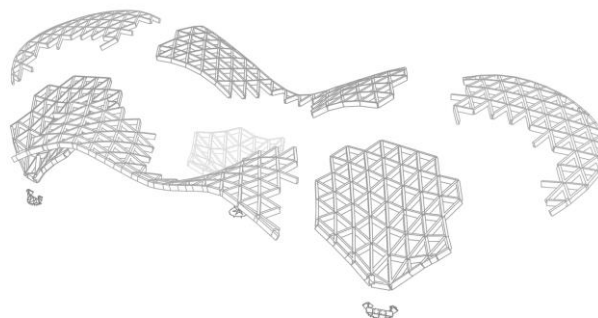
tech Form-finding and Optimization for 3D-printing

role ITECH Course: Form-finding
2017 ITKE Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

task Entire Process



The aim of this project is to create series of bus stations as a part of VVS in Stuttgart based on funicular timber grid shell.

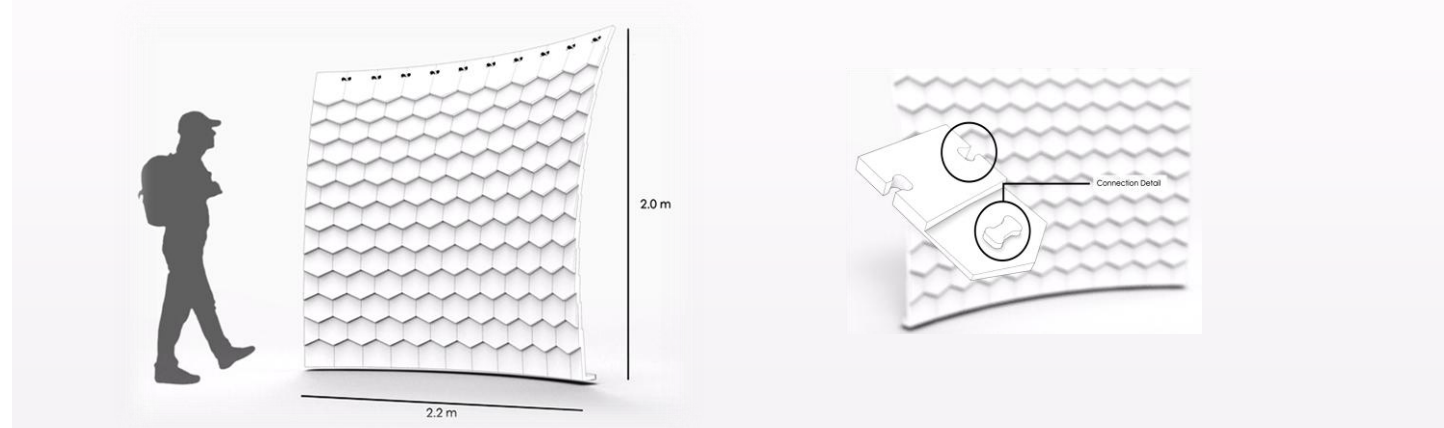


work **SHINGLE WALL**
Shingle Component

tech Computational Design and Robotic Fabrication

role ITECH Group Project
2018 ICD Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

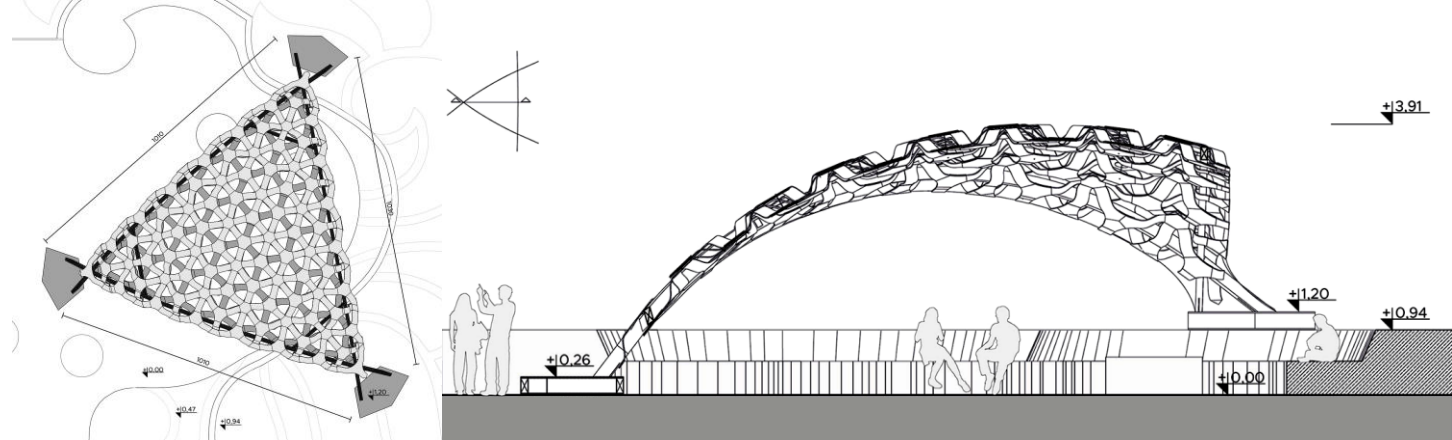
task Entire Process



The Shingle Wall is a robotically fabricated segmented synclastic shell, which is the outcome of the robotic milling assignment of ITECH's Computational Design and Fabrication Seminar 2018.



work **BIOMAT PAVILION**
Bio-composite Flexible Wood Segmental Shell
tech Vacuum Molding Bio-material
role Student Assistant (HiWi)
2018 BioMat Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE
task Manufacturing and Assembly



The pavilion is a double-curved, parametrically designed segmental shell of light, single-curved wood and bio-composite elements supported by three curved crossed wooden beams.



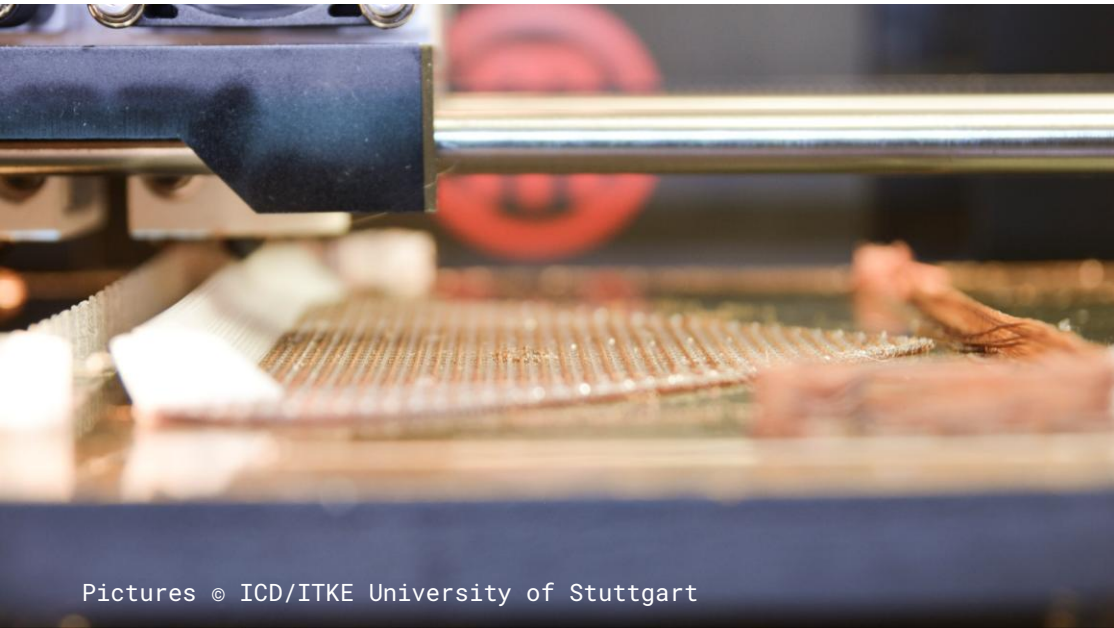
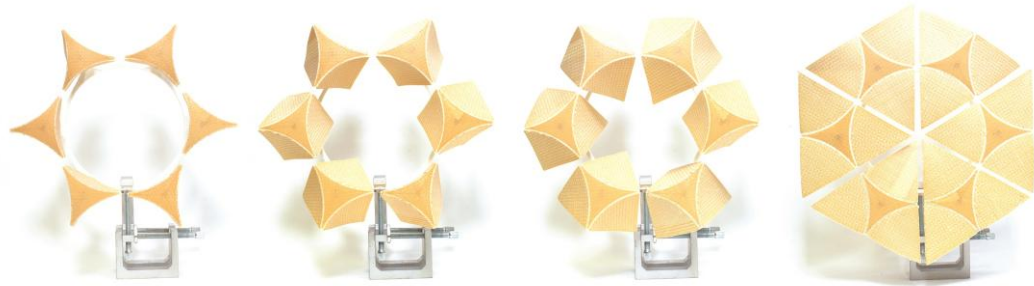
work **SMART BIO STRUCTURE**
Passive Adaptive Façade System

tech 4D Printed Programmable Hygroscopic Wood

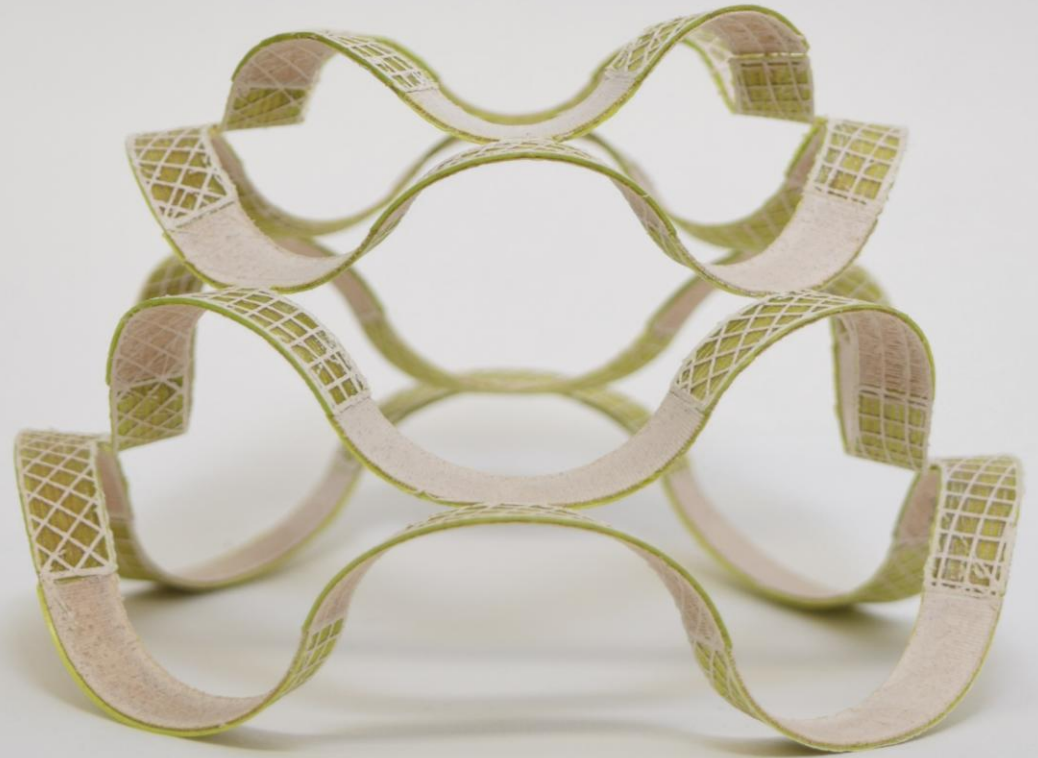
role Student Assistant (HiWi)

2019 ICD Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

task Simulation and Production



The potentials of programmable 4D-printing of wood filament to create environmentally passive responsive facade systems.

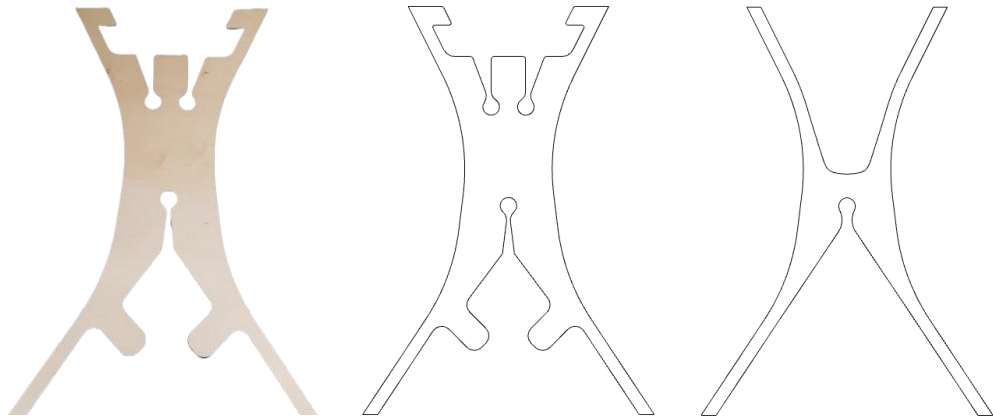


work **ODIN CHAIR**
Bending-active Structure

tech Experimental Prototyping of CNC Plywood

role ITECH Course: Chair Design
2019 BioMat Institute, University of Stuttgart, DE

task Entire Process



The prepared CNC plywood layers were bended and connected in specific points leading to a 3D deformation from 2D sheets which, as a result, provided structural stiffness. To see the video, click [here](#).

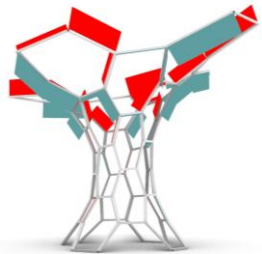
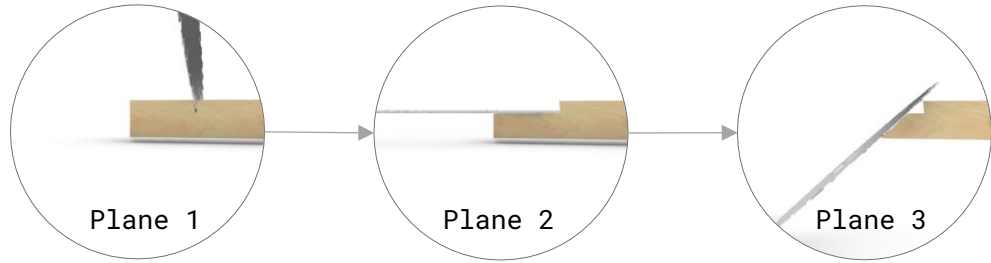
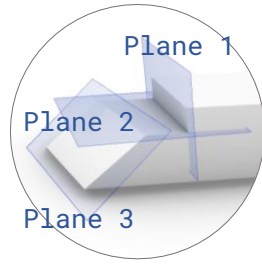


work **HEXA TOWER**
Triple Scarf Timber Joinery

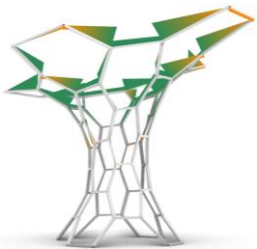
tech FEA and Fabrication Method

role Research Project
2020 IVB Institute, NTNU i Gjøvik

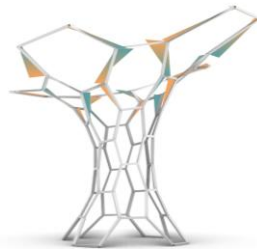
task Entire Process



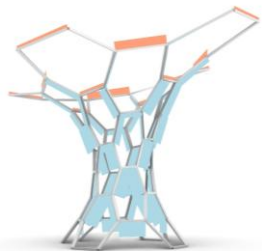
Mx



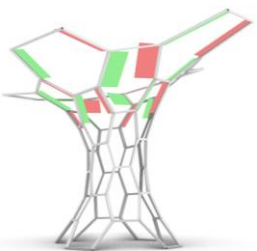
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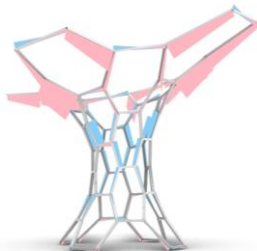
Mz



Nx

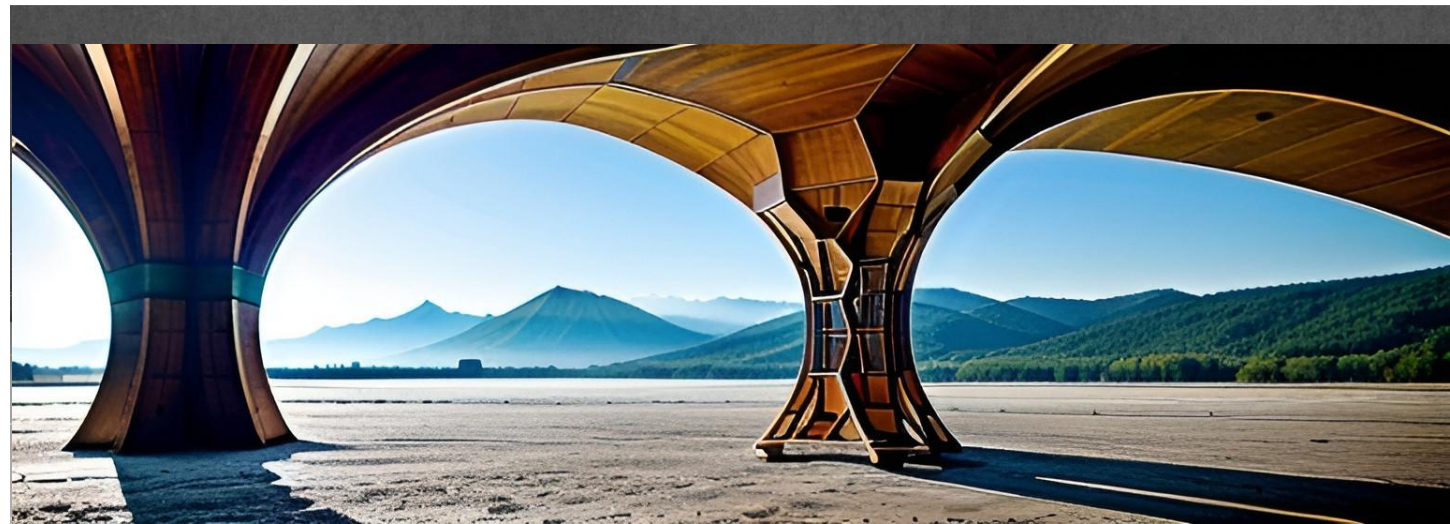
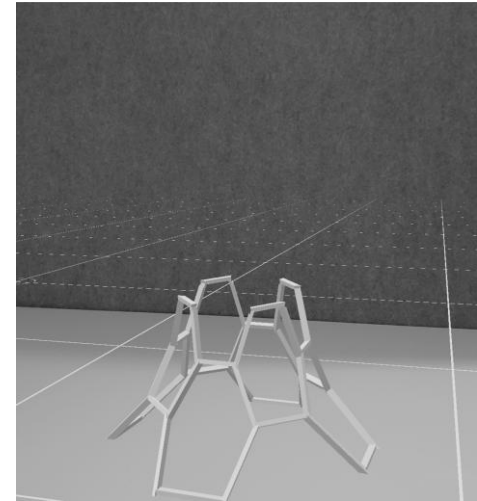
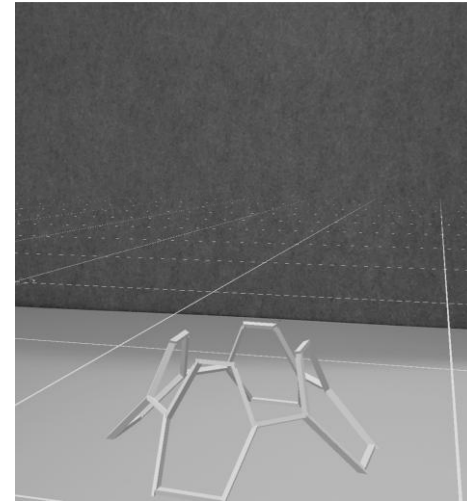
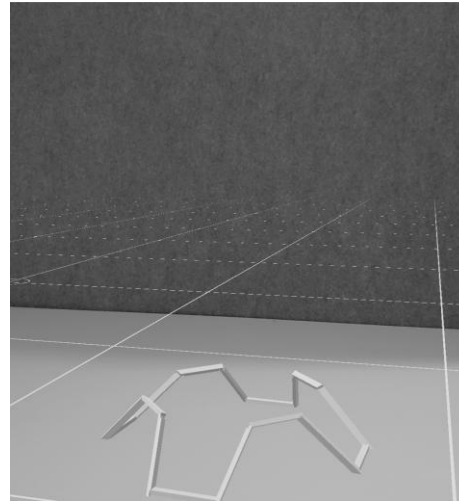
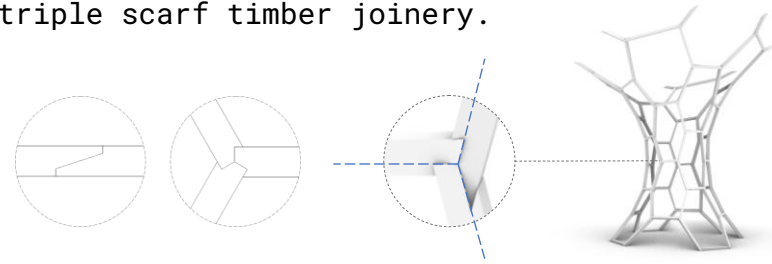


Vy



Vz

The aim of this project is to rethink of vernacular scarf joinery and extend it for triple scarf timber joinery.



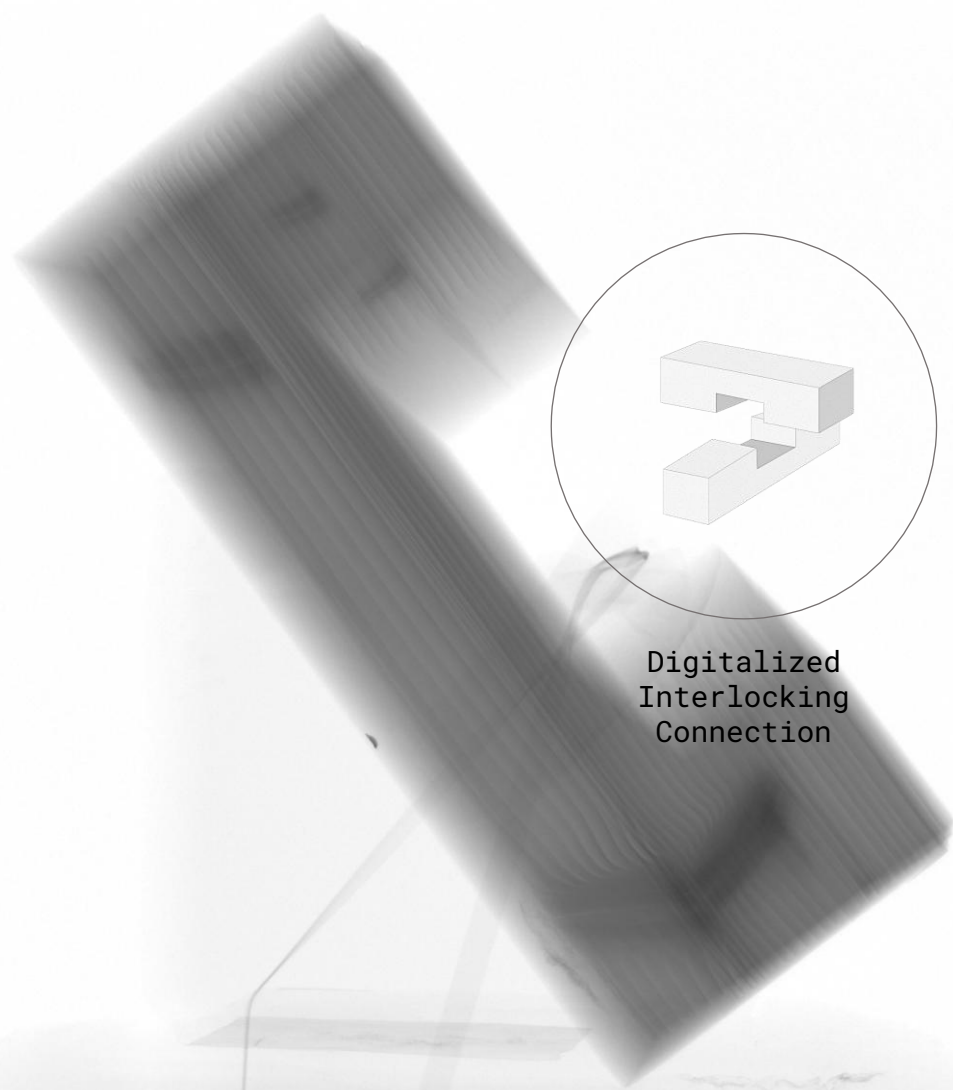
work **INTER-HYGRO-JOINERY**
Encapsulating Interlocking Timber Joinery

tech Hygroscopic Study of Wooden Joinery via CT Scanning

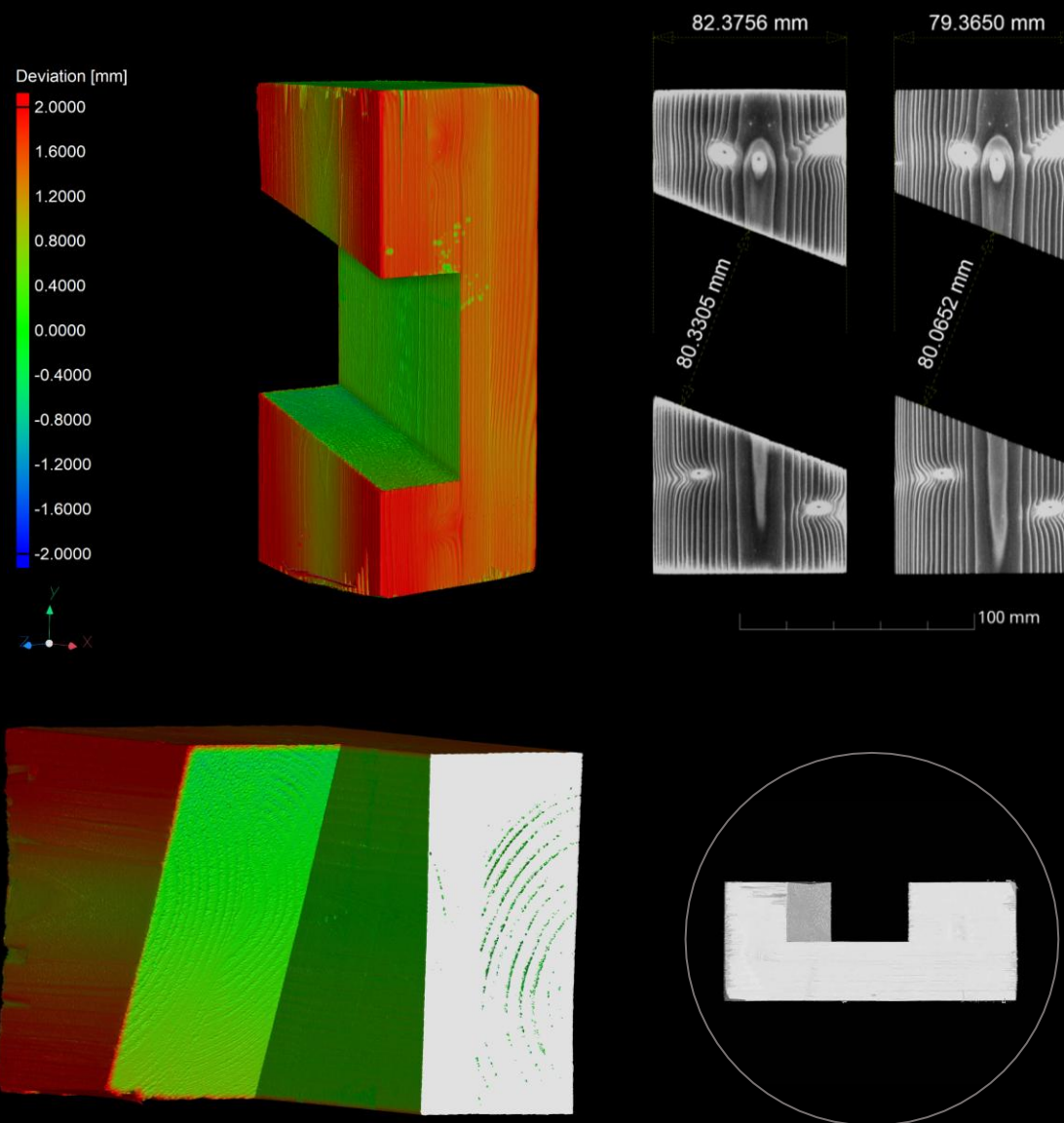
role Research Project

2021 IVB Institute, NTNU i Gjøvik, NO

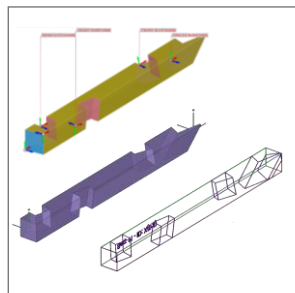
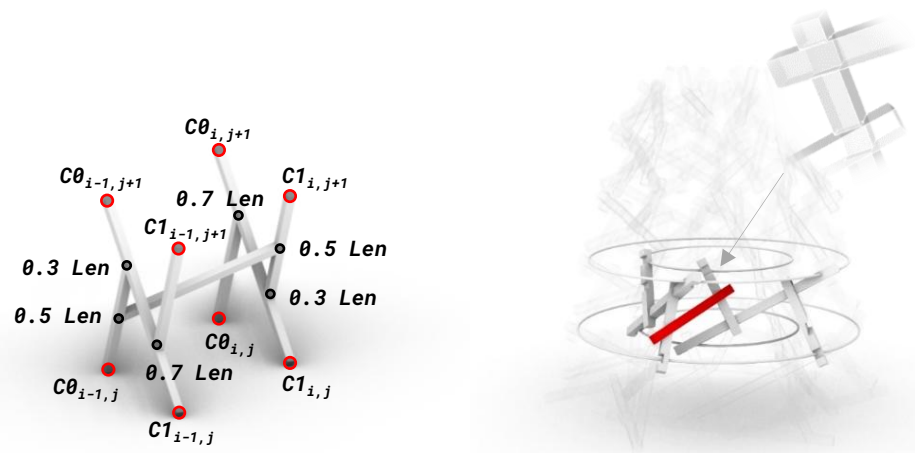
task Entire Process



Investigation of wood's hygroscopicity via CT scanner to reinforce the structural capacity of interlocking connections.



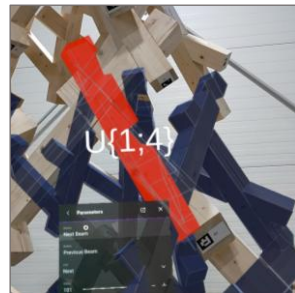
work **INTERLOCKING TOWER**
Sequential Circular Augmented Construction
tech Hundegger Production and Sequential AR Assembly
role Research Project
2022 IVB Institute, NTNU i Gjøvik & Østlaft AG, NO
task Entire Process



Computational
Design



Hundegger
Fabrication



Augmented
Assembly

How innovative structures are realized through synthesizing of interlocking joinery, and how augmented-reality assembly could enable the circular economy in wood construction (?)



work **MODULAR HOUSING**
Serial Timber Housing

tech Modular Timber Construction and Production

role Full-time Employment

2023 *timpla GmbH, Eberswalde-Berlin, DE (timpla.eu)*

task Timber Construction Design

Germany's largest wooden module factory ...
We are industrializing wooden modular construction to establish it as the strongest and most sustainable alternative for residential and commercial construction.



Foto: Gataric Fotografie



Foto: Ruedi Walti



Foto: Stefan Hofmann, Biel